

A COZY MURDER MYSTERY PARTY GAME

The Gravy Boat MURDER

A Cozy Friendsgiving Murder Mystery

6-12 PLAYERS · 90 MIN-2.5 HOURS · PRINTABLE PDF

START HERE

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

READ ME FIRST

Start *Here*



Thank you for choosing The Gravy Boat Murder, a cozy Friendsgiving murder mystery for 6–12 players. Here is what each file is for and who should look at it.

FILE	WHO READS IT	WHAT IT IS
00 START HERE	The host	This file: what to print, print totals and FAQ.
01 Host Guide	The host	Checklist, casting, timetables, Scripts 1–4, tips. No spoilers.
02 Invitations	Guests	12 character invitations, 1 open invitation, a text version.
03 Cast List	Everyone	Public bios, outfit ideas and dishes.
04 Potluck Planner	The host	Dish assignments, allergies and 12 dish tents.
10–21 Booklets	One player each	10–15 are in every game; 16–21 are optional.
22 All Booklets Combined	The host	All 12 booklets in one file, for one-click printing.
30 Evidence Cards	A helper cuts them	E1–E12 plus optional card backs.
31–34	Everyone	Name tags, ballots, Detective Notes, tents, banner and awards.
99 SOLUTION	A player, last	The answer and Script 5. Do not open until every ballot is in.

Print in this order

1. 01 Host Guide, then read it.
2. The booklets for your guest count (casting chart in 01), single-sided.
3. 02 if you want printed invitations, then 03, 04, 30 (a helper cuts it), 31, 32, 33, 34.
4. 99 last, face down, without looking.

THREE GOLDEN RULES

Don't open file 99 until every ballot is in. **Print booklets single-sided** (or cut page 3 on its dashed line) so later rounds can't show through. **Ask another guest or a family member to cut the evidence cards** and fill the envelopes, so the host can play too.

Print List

Page totals for one set. The kit is the same for every party: 01 Host Guide (15), 03 Cast List (3), 04 Potluck Planner (2), 30 Evidence Cards (3), 31 Name Tags (2), 32 Accusation Ballots (1), 33 Detective Notes (1), 34 Awards & Decor (4), 99 Solution (5) = 36 pages.

PLAYERS	BOOKLETS	BOOKLET PAGES	KIT PAGES	TOTAL PAGES
6	10–15	6 × 4 = 24	36	**60**
7	10–16	7 × 4 = 28	36	**64**
8	10–17	8 × 4 = 32	36	**68**
9	10–18	9 × 4 = 36	36	**72**
10	10–19	10 × 4 = 40	36	**76**
11	10–20	11 × 4 = 44	36	**80**
12	10–21	12 × 4 = 48	36	**84**

EXTRA COPIES (NOT COUNTED ABOVE)

33 Detective Notes: one per player, so print it (players − 1) more times. 32 Ballots: one sheet per four players. 02 Invitations (8 pages) are optional: you can send the text version instead. 30 Evidence Cards page 3 (card backs) is optional.

PREFER ONE FILE?

22 All Booklets Combined holds all 12 booklets (48 pages). Booklet 10 is pages 1–4, booklet 11 is pages 5–8, and so on up to booklet 21 on pages 45–48. Print only the page ranges you need.

13-16 GUESTS

Print the 12-player set; duos share optional booklets (see the casting chart in the Host Guide).

Questions & Answers

6 QUICK ANSWERS

Can the host play?

Yes. Take booklet 10 or 11 (the casting chart says so) and ask a helper to cut the evidence cards. The Host Guide never reveals the answer.

Is it OK for teens and grandparents?

Yes. It's PG and suits ages 12 and up: no adult jokes, no flirting, no drinking tasks and nothing gory. Goldie simply never wakes from a nap in her rocking chair.

We're not American. Does it still work?

Yes. It's a Friendsgiving among friends, not a history lesson, and every file comes in A4 as well as US Letter. Canadian Thanksgiving or an autumn dinner party in the UK or Australia works just as well.

Can we play after dinner in 90 minutes?

Yes. The Express timetable in the Host Guide runs exactly 90 minutes, and there is a 60-minute plan too.

Do we have to drink?

No. There are no drinking tasks, the cider in the story is alcohol-free and every drink idea in the Host Guide is alcohol-free.

Black-and-white printing?

Yes. Text is near-black on light pages, and every round, card and optional character is labeled in words, not only by color.

> ABOUT THIS GAME
>
> The Gravy Boat Murder is an original story by Clue & Candle Games, written with AI assistance, then edited by hand and checked clue by clue for fair play and timeline consistency. Any resemblance to real people or places is coincidental.

> HELP
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> Questions or a printing problem? Email chenphien@gmail.com. Refunds within 14 days of purchase.